

Opera Mini 6 in AppStore

After much waiting, iOS customers can finally use Opera Mini 6 on their devices.

Can't touch the TouchPad?

HP's Eric Cador boldly declared the upcoming webOS TouchPad tablet will be the best in the market. Will it deliver?

Mango update brings 500 new features to Windows Phone 7

Microsoft further detailed the Mango update for Windows Phone 7 at a press conference in New York on May 24, an update that brings 500 new features to the platform, and will take the version number to Windows Phone 7.1, rather than 7.5 as previously rumoured. The release date was left nearly as ambiguous as before - sometime in Fall.

The biggest change is true multitasking, allowing users to switch between all types of apps, including third party apps, which will continue to work in the background. Andy Lees, president of Microsoft's Mobile Communication Business, added: "Third-party applications have been freed from their silos...They're [now] part of the total experience."

Live Tiles have been improved, enabling better glance-and-go information and notifications. Other changes include a version of Internet Explorer 9 (left) for the Win-

dows Phone platform - apparently faster than any other mobile browser out there, a new unified linked inbox, a thread-based IM aggregator, and a new Groups-based contact system. Twitter, LinkedIn, and Facebook are all natively integrated.

Also new was the native application - Local Scout - providing real-time local search results and recommendations for dining, shopping, and entertainment, as well as Quick Cards, giving brief descriptions of related apps, events, and products in search results. Improved Bing for WP7.1 also brings Visual Search and Music search to the fore. WP7.1 will also feature App Connect, an improved way to discover apps in web-based searches.

While Windows Phone Marketplace has over 18,000 apps, and has grown rapidly, we can't help but wonder if it will be enough for Microsoft to carve back a niche in the smartphone market. ■

Samsung Galaxy S II launches in India, priced at ₹32,890

The Samsung Galaxy S II (16 GB) is officially on its way to India. It is destined for shelves with a June 10 retail release date and ₹32,890 price tag, and can be pre-ordered now. The Galaxy



S II can however be procured a week earlier, as Vodafone has exclusive launch deal, offering the it online at the same ₹32,890

price tag, from June 3.

What's pleasantly surprising is the almost modest price of the Galaxy S II, a phone that can rest easy with the expectations of being Samsung's flagship handheld. Endowed with specs more than sufficient to take on any competitor in the market (definitely, the more expensive Indian iPhone 4), we're glad a top-end premium was not stuck onto this product. Elsewhere, a high price was one of the few cons in a long list of positive reviews of the product.

Salient features of this Android 2.3 Gingerbread include a 4.3-inch Super AMOLED Plus 480x800 display, a dual-core 1.2GHz Exynos processor with a Mali 400 GPU, 8MP camera 1080p HD video recording, and 16GB of inbuilt storage for the base model. ■

Apple iPhone 4 comes to India with Airtel and Aircel

After various announcements, the last of which was more than a month and a half ago, operators Airtel and Aircel are finally making good on their claims of bringing the iPhone 4 to India. At the time of writing, the duo announced the iPhone 4 will be launching by May 27, almost a year after it was launched in the United States, last June. So far, only Aircel has revealed pricing, and as expected, it has a slight premium attached.

The 16GB Apple iPhone 4 will retail for Rs. 34,500, and, the 32GB version will retail for Rs. 40,900. A requisite bumper, to avoid the 'death grip', will be charged for separately. We were hoping the iPhone 4 would

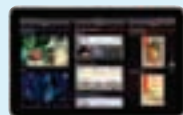
launch with some sort of contract, enabling customers to buy it at a lower price. Aircel has come up with some plans, but we aren't too sure they will entice customers.

Aircel postpaid customers will be able to get the phone for "free" in the Premium Money Back plan, by paying up front, and then availing voice and data plans that are equal to the phone's value, valid for 24 months. The Advantage Money Back plan is the same thing, at half the phone's value and for one year validity. Let us hope Airtel comes up with better plans.

For more details on iPhone 4, Galaxy S II, and Windows Phone 7, refer our up-to-date online coverage at www.thinkdigit.com. ■

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